

Koichiro Iwao (AlmaLinux contributor) said, “Although I had previously contributed to AlmaLinux Raspberry Pi images, I didn’t know much about the boot process. It took considerable time and effort to successfully build a kernel on my ARM environment, overcoming failed builds and boot issues along the way. These attempts allowed me to understand the Raspberry Pi boot process more deeply and identify what was going wrong.”



In the realm of computing, while traditional desktop and laptop computers generally have the flexibility to boot any Linux distribution of choice, the situation with single-board computers is quite distinct. Most single-board computers necessitate an operating system image that is specifically tailored with drivers and kernel extensions to suit their unique hardware configuration. This means that introducing support for a new model, even if it’s a successor to an already supported board, requires considerable effort.

The AlmaLinux image for the Raspberry Pi 5 comes with the GNOME desktop environment and is built on the Linux 6.6 LTS kernel. To download the official image, visit the AlmaLinux download page. Navigate to the ARM tab and scroll down to the Raspberry Pi section. Here, you can choose to download the images for either the 9.4 or the 8.10 release.

Support for local DEB packages now available on Ubuntu’s app centre

Here’s some great news for Ubuntu users running the latest Ubuntu 23.10 (Mantic Minotaur) or Ubuntu 24.04 LTS (Noble Numbat) releases -- the App Center application has been updated to allow the installation of locally downloaded DEB packages.

Originally, when Canonical replaced the Ubuntu Software Center with the App Center—a graphical interface to Canonical’s Snap Store—in the Ubuntu 23.10 release, it omitted the capability to handle locally downloaded DEB packages. This limitation persisted with the introduction of Ubuntu 24.04 LTS, where users found they could not install DEB packages downloaded from the internet using the App Center, along with other drawbacks like not being able to update all packages to the newest version simultaneously.

While experienced users might have defaulted to using the command line to install these DEB packages, the scenario was less ideal for newcomers or those accustomed to the more user-friendly Ubuntu Software Center.

However, the wait is over. The App Center now supports the installation of externally downloaded DEB packages. To install a DEB package, users need

New TrueNAS version released

iXsystems has announced the production release of TrueNAS SCALE 24.04 and its new series of hybrid storage appliances, the TrueNAS Enterprise H-Series. TrueNAS 24.04, the fourth major version of the company’s Linux-based data platform software, aims to provide data freedom by improving flexibility, interoperability, and storage efficiency.

Codenamed ‘Dragonfish’, TrueNAS 24.04 brings advancements in security, performance, and functionality. It features a simplified Share Creation workflow, and the TrueNAS web UI now manages open client sessions for both SMB and NFS file sharing protocols.

The TrueNAS Enterprise H-Series, the latest addition to the company’s storage portfolio, offers dual-controller configurations and options for hybrid or all-flash storage. The H-Series provides reliable storage for cost-optimised workloads at the edge or data centre, scaling up to 2 petabytes (PB) in capacity. The series includes the TrueNAS H10 and the forthcoming H20, both in a compact 2U form factor. Its typical power consumption of 100-300 watts meets sustainability initiatives, while the dual-controller architecture ensures continuous accessibility with over 99.999% uptime. Optional 24, 60, or 102-bay expansion shelves allow growth from 20TB all-flash to 2PB hybrid storage.

Morgan Littlewood, senior vice president of product management at iXsystems, stated that the availability of the new TrueNAS Enterprise H-Series, powered by TrueNAS 24.04, advances the world’s most widely deployed storage software. The H-Series offers the smallest and lowest power footprint, while the M-Series and F-Series deliver hybrid scalability and all-flash performance.

The H-Series appliances and Enterprise 24.04 software are now available. The community edition, TrueNAS SCALE 24.04, is free to download or upgrade to.